

New Functional Requirement Document (FRD)

“Decision Point”

1. Purpose

The purpose of this feature is to provide every Resource in System with a **simple, formal and auditable mechanism to raise a Point related to their allocated work or operational responsibility** and obtain an appropriate managerial response through the existing Resource Owner hierarchy.

The feature is intentionally designed as a **lean governance mechanism** and shall not become a messaging, collaboration, ticketing or discussion utility.

The fundamental operating principle shall be:

Raise → Record View → Decide or Escalate → Audit

Every managerial level shall remain accountable for the view and decision recorded by them.

2. Business Objectives

The feature shall:

- Allow every Resource to formally raise a Point requiring visibility, acknowledgement, decision or approval.
 - Link relevant Points with actual work allocation wherever applicable.
 - Automatically route the Point through the existing Resource Owner hierarchy.
 - Allow each Resource Owner to exercise managerial judgment rather than forcing predefined approval levels.
 - Capture mandatory Remarks/Comments from every person taking an action.
 - Allow a Resource Owner to close a Point at their own level where appropriate.
 - Allow escalation to the next Resource Owner where higher-level judgment is considered necessary.
 - Maintain complete accountability for who raised, recommended, escalated, approved, rejected or acknowledged a Point.
 - Avoid informal issues becoming untraceable through verbal discussions or chat conversations.
 - Provide management with visibility into decision-making and escalation behaviour across the organization.
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3. Core Design Principles

3.1 Resource Owner Driven

Every Resource already has a single Resource Owner in System.

The system shall use this existing hierarchy for routing.

No separate escalation hierarchy shall be maintained.

3.2 No Authority Matrix

System shall **not maintain an authority matrix defining who is permitted to approve which type of Point**.

Every Resource Owner shall be considered capable of exercising managerial judgment.

A Resource Owner may:

- close the Point at their level; or
- recommend escalation to their own Resource Owner.

The person taking the final decision becomes accountable for that decision through the audit trail.

3.3 No Recipient Selection

Neither the raiser nor an intermediate Resource Owner shall manually select the next recipient.

Routing shall always follow:

Resource → Immediate RO → RO's RO → Next RO → ...

This prevents selective escalation or bypassing the organizational hierarchy.

3.4 No Messaging Behaviour

The feature shall not provide:

- Chat
- Conversation threads
- Reply chains
- @mentions
- Back-and-forth discussions
- Internal messaging
- User-selected forwarding
- Multiple clarification cycles
- Attachments-based conversations
- Task delegation within a Point

If further discussion is required, users may use their normal organizational communication channels. System shall capture the **formal Point, managerial view and final outcome**.

4. Point Types

System shall maintain a single system-defined Point Type master applicable across the organization. Initial Point Types may include:

Point Type	Purpose
Clarification	Resource requires formal clarity regarding allocated work or direction
Concern	Resource wants to formally highlight a concern
Exception Request	Resource requests deviation from an existing process, instruction or expectation
Change Request	Resource proposes a change affecting allocated work
Dependency / Blocker	Resource identifies something preventing or affecting execution
Decision Required	Resource requires a managerial decision
Approval Required	Resource explicitly requires managerial approval

Point Types shall remain simple classification values.

No dynamic fields or different forms shall be generated based on Point Type.

5. Raise Point

5.1 Eligibility

Any active Resource in System shall be allowed to raise a Point.

5.2 Raise Point Fields

Field	Requirement
Point ID	System generated
Point Type	Mandatory
Subject / Point Title	Mandatory
Remarks / Comments	Mandatory
Work Allocation Reference	Conditional
Project	Auto-derived where Work Allocation is linked
Raised By	System captured
Resource Owner	System derived
Raised Date & Time	System captured
Status	System managed

The primary input from the Resource shall remain **Remarks / Comments**.
No elaborate structured form shall be introduced.

6. Work Allocation Linkage

Where the Point relates to allocated work, the Resource shall be able to link the Point with the relevant Work Allocation.

For selected Point Types, Work Allocation linkage may be configured as mandatory.

Example:

Point Type	Work Linkage
Clarification	Conditional
Concern	Optional
Exception Request	Conditional
Change Request	Mandatory where related to allocated work
Dependency / Blocker	Mandatory where related to allocated work
Decision Required	Conditional
Approval Required	Conditional

When linked, the reviewing RO shall be able to see essential work context without navigating away unnecessarily.

This may include:

- Project
- Activity / Work Allocation
- Resource
- Planned dates
- Current status
- Relevant allocation details

The Point feature shall **reference existing work data rather than duplicate it**.

7. Point Submission

Upon submission:

1. System generates Point ID.
2. Status becomes **Pending RO Action**.
3. Immediate Resource Owner is automatically identified.
4. Point appears in that RO's actionable queue.
5. Submission details become part of the permanent audit history.

The raiser cannot manually forward the Point to another manager.

8. Resource Owner Review

The RO shall see:

- Point ID
- Point Type
- Subject
- Raised By
- Raised Date/Time
- Remarks / Comments from raiser
- Linked Work Allocation, where applicable
- Relevant work/project context
- Previous escalation history, where applicable
- Current status

The RO shall then select one of four actions.

9. Resource Owner Actions

9.1 Acknowledge & Close

Used where the Point does not require an approval/rejection decision but managerial acknowledgement is sufficient.

Examples:

- Concern noted
- Operational observation
- Information requiring managerial visibility
- Blocker already understood/resolved

Remarks / Comments shall be mandatory.

Result:

Status → Acknowledged & Closed

9.2 Approve & Close

The RO determines that the requested Point can be approved at their level.

Remarks / Comments shall be mandatory.

Result:

Status → Approved & Closed

The system shall record the approving RO as the person accountable for the approval.

9.3 Reject & Close

The RO determines that the Point should not proceed.

This action may also be used where:

- information provided is insufficient;
- Point is unclear;
- request is inappropriate;
- Point does not justify further escalation.

Remarks / Comments shall be mandatory.

Result:

Status → Rejected & Closed

There shall be **no Return for Clarification workflow**.

If necessary, the Resource may subsequently raise a fresh Point with clearer information.

9.4 Recommend & Escalate

The RO believes that the Point requires judgment or decision from the next level.

RO shall provide their:

- View
- Recommendation
- Reason for escalation

through the mandatory **Remarks / Comments** field.

The system automatically identifies the RO's own Resource Owner.

Result:

Status → Escalated – Pending Next RO

The next RO receives:

- Original Point
- Original raiser's Remarks/Comments
- Work Allocation context
- Previous RO's Remarks/Recommendation
- Complete escalation trail

The next RO receives exactly the same four action choices.

10. Multi-Level Escalation

There shall be **no fixed L1/L2/L3 approval structure**.

A Point may naturally travel:

Resource → RO → RO's RO → RO's RO → ...

At every managerial level, the RO shall decide:

Do I take responsibility for closing this Point, or should I formally recommend escalation?

This continues until an RO selects:

- Acknowledge & Close
- Approve & Close
- Reject & Close

Therefore, the final approver/decision-maker is determined by **managerial judgment rather than system configuration**.

11. Self-Resolved Point

Before the first RO has taken any action, the raiser may mark the Point as:

Self-Resolved

The Resource shall provide mandatory **Remarks / Comments** explaining the resolution.

Upon confirmation:

Status → Self-Resolved & Closed

The Point shall immediately leave the RO's actionable queue.

No RO acknowledgement shall be required.

The complete Point shall nevertheless remain available in history and reporting.

This ensures that the person choosing Self-Resolved remains explicitly accountable for that action.

Once any RO has acted upon the Point, **Self-Resolved shall no longer be available**.

12. Point Status Lifecycle

The primary statuses shall be:

Status	Meaning
Pending RO Action	Submitted and awaiting immediate RO
Escalated – Pending Next RO	Current RO recommended escalation
Acknowledged & Closed	RO acknowledged and closed
Approved & Closed	RO approved and closed
Rejected & Closed	RO rejected and closed
Self-Resolved & Closed	Raiser resolved before first RO action

Closed Points shall not permit further actions.

13. My Points

Every Resource shall have access to **My Points**.

The screen shall show Points raised by the logged-in Resource.

Suggested grid:

Field

Point ID

Date

Point Type

Subject

Work Reference

Current With

Status

Last Action Date

Field

Final Decision By

The Resource may open any Point to see its complete history.

There shall be no reply/chat facility.

14. Points Requiring My Action

Every Resource Owner shall have a simple actionable area:

Points Requiring My Action

Suggested grid:

Field

Point ID

Raised Date

Raised By

Point Type

Subject

Work / Project

Previous RO

Escalation Level

Pending Since

Opening the Point shall display the Point context followed by the available action buttons.

This should behave as an **action queue**, not an inbox or messaging interface.

15. Point Detail View

The Point Detail screen shall preferably contain three compact sections.

Section A – Point

- Point ID
- Type
- Subject
- Raised By
- Raised On
- Original Remarks / Comments

Section B – Work Context

Displayed only where linked.

- Project
- Work Allocation
- Relevant allocation information

Section C – Decision Trail

Example:

Raised – Resource A

Remarks: ...

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Recommended & Escalated – Manager B

Remarks: ...

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Recommended & Escalated – Manager C

Remarks: ...

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Approved & Closed – Manager D

Remarks: ...

This becomes the central accountability view.

16. Remarks / Comments Principle

Remarks / Comments shall be mandatory for every human action within this feature.

This includes:

- Raising Point
- Self-Resolved
- Acknowledge & Close
- Approve & Close
- Reject & Close
- Recommend & Escalate

An action shall not be submitted with blank Remarks/Comments.

This ensures that System captures not merely **what somebody did**, but also **why they did it**.

17. Audit Trail

Every Point shall maintain an immutable audit history.

The system shall capture:

Audit Element	Captured
Action	Yes
Performed By	Yes
Resource / Role	Yes
Date & Time	Yes
Remarks / Comments	Yes
Previous Status	Yes
New Status	Yes
Previous RO	Where applicable
Next RO	Where applicable
Work Reference	Where applicable

Submitted Remarks/Comments shall not be editable retrospectively.

Closed Points shall remain permanently available according to System's standard data retention policy.

18. Notifications

Notifications shall remain minimal and action-oriented.

Raiser

Notify when:

- Point is Acknowledged & Closed
- Point is Approved & Closed
- Point is Rejected & Closed

Resource Owner

Notify when:

- New Point requires their action
- An escalated Point reaches them

Intermediate ROs do not require notifications for every subsequent action unless specifically required later.

The feature should avoid excessive notification behaviour.

19. Access & Visibility

Resource

Can:

- Raise Point
- View own Points
- Self-Resolve before first RO action
- View complete decision history of own Points

Cannot:

- Choose recipient
- Modify submitted Point
- Withdraw submitted Point
- Reply to RO remarks
- Reopen closed Point

Resource Owner

Can:

- View Points currently requiring their action
- View Point/work context
- Add Remarks/Comments
- Acknowledge
- Approve
- Reject
- Recommend & Escalate
- View Points previously acted upon by them

Management / Authorized Governance Users

May be provided organization-level read/report visibility according to existing System permissions.

20. Explicit Non-Goals

The following are specifically outside the scope of this feature:

- Messenger
- Teams/Slack replacement
- Discussion threads
- Comments conversation
- Ticketing/helpdesk
- Task management
- Workflow designer
- Configurable approval workflows
- Authority matrix
- Delegation matrix
- Manual recipient selection
- CC/BCC concepts
- Multiple clarification loops
- Collaborative document exchange
- Parallel approvals
- Voting/consensus mechanisms

These exclusions are important to preserve the simplicity of the capability.

21. Management Visibility

The feature shall provide management visibility without creating another large dashboard.

Useful measures may be incorporated into existing System views:

- Open Points
- Points Pending RO Action
- Points Escalated
- Average Decision Time
- Approved / Rejected / Acknowledged
- Self-Resolved Points

- Points by Type
- Points by Department
- Points by Resource Owner
- Escalation frequency

These should primarily support **management behaviour and governance visibility**, rather than operational ticket tracking.

22. Future Analytical Possibilities

Once sufficient historical data exists, System can derive useful organizational signals such as:

Decision Ownership

Which managers close Points at their own level versus escalating them?

Escalation Behaviour

Which departments or managers show unusually high escalation rates?

Decision Turnaround

How long do different managerial levels take to act?

Organizational Friction

Which Point Types repeatedly arise from particular departments/projects?

Resource Behaviour

Which Resources frequently raise Points, and how many are subsequently Approved, Rejected, Acknowledged or Self-Resolved?

These analytics are future possibilities and **shall not complicate the Phase-1 implementation**.

23. Key Business Rules

1. Every active Resource may raise a Point.
 2. Every Point must have a Point Type.
 3. Every Point must contain Remarks/Comments.
 4. Work Allocation linkage shall be mandatory only for configured applicable Point Types.
 5. First recipient shall always be the raiser's immediate Resource Owner.
 6. Recipient cannot be manually selected.
 7. Every RO action requires Remarks/Comments.
 8. Any RO may Acknowledge, Approve or Reject and close the Point.
 9. Any RO may Recommend & Escalate.
 10. Escalation shall always go automatically to that RO's Resource Owner.
 11. No separate authority matrix shall determine final approval authority.
 12. No Return for Clarification action shall exist.
 13. Raiser cannot withdraw a submitted Point.
 14. Raiser may Self-Resolve only until the first RO action.
 15. Self-Resolved Points close immediately.
 16. Closed Points cannot be reopened.
 17. Submitted remarks cannot subsequently be modified.
 18. Complete action history shall remain auditable.
 19. No conversation/thread mechanism shall exist.
 20. A new Point must be raised if a closed matter requires fresh consideration.
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24. Expected Business Outcome

This capability shall create a lightweight formal layer between **work execution and managerial accountability**.

It gives every Resource a mechanism to formally state:

“I want this Point to be on record.”

It simultaneously requires every Resource Owner receiving that Point to state:

“This is my view, and I am either taking the decision or consciously escalating it.”

The resulting organizational behaviour is expected to improve:

- Decision accountability
- Managerial ownership
- Escalation discipline
- Visibility of employee concerns and requests
- Traceability of important decisions
- Transparency of managerial reasoning
- Evidence-based management reviews

Most importantly, System shall achieve this **without becoming another communication platform or introducing complex approval bureaucracy.**

Final Functional Philosophy

Hierarchy determines where the Point travels.

Judgment determines where it stops.

Remarks capture the rationale.

Audit establishes accountability.